

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

SUPREME COURT

Path open for Trump to roll back citizenship

Justices limit stays by federal courts, but effect still up in air

By Mark Sherman
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — A united conservative majority of the Supreme Court ruled Friday that federal judges lack the authority to grant nationwide injunctions, but the decision left unclear whether President Donald Trump's restrictions on birthright citizenship could soon take effect in parts of the country.

The outcome represented a victory for Trump, who has complained about judges throwing up obstacles to his agenda. Nationwide, or universal, injunctions had emerged as an important check on the Republican president's efforts to expand executive power and remake the government and a source of mounting frustration to him and his allies.

But the court left open the possibility that the birthright citizenship changes could remain blocked nationwide. Trump's order would deny citizenship to U.S.-born children of people who are in the country illegally or temporarily.

The cases now return to lower courts, where judges will have to decide how to tailor their orders to comply with the high court ruling, which was written by Justice Amy Coney Barrett. Enforcement of the policy can't take place for another 30 days, Barrett wrote.

Even then it's unclear whether the court's decision could produce a confusing patchwork of rules that might differ in the 22 states that sued over the Trump order and the rest of the country.

The justices agreed with the Trump administration, as well as President Joe Biden's Democratic administration before it, that judges are overreach-

Turn to Court, Page 6

HIGH COURT UPHOLDS OBAMACARE MANDATE: The Supreme Court has preserved a key part of the Affordable Care Act's preventive health care coverage requirements, rejecting a challenge from Christian employers to the provision that affects 150 million Americans.

Nation & World

"They do those cuts, and I don't know how people like me on certain medications, how we're supposed to survive and live. I know I'm not the only person out there that's terrified of what's going to happen." — Kristina Lewis, 64, of Alsip



'HAVING MEDICAID KEEPS ME ALIVE'

Illinois residents anxiously watching as Congress considers hundreds of billions in nationwide cuts



Above: Cornelia Simms, of Chicago's Auburn Gresham neighborhood, fears work requirements could make it difficult for her to stay on Medicaid — even though she has a job. **Top:** Kristina Lewis, of Alsip, relies on Medicaid to stretch her monthly Social Security disability payments.

EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

By Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

Across Illinois, millions of people are anxiously awaiting the next move on a bill that would cut hundreds of billions of dollars from Medicaid across the country.

The "One Big Beautiful Bill Act" would slash the program, which provides health care coverage to people with low incomes, in order to help pay for tax cuts and border and national security. President Donald Trump and congressional Republicans say the bill would cut waste, fraud and abuse from Medicaid, providing coverage only to those who truly need it.

But Democrats, health care leaders and patients say it would devastate those who rely on the program, and the hospitals that serve all patients. Across Illinois, 3.4 million people are on Medicaid — about one-fourth of the state's population.

Depending on which proposals are adopted, Illinois could lose billions of dollars

Turn to Medicaid, Page 2

Chicago man convicted of helping Islamic State

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Nearly seven years after the feds raided his Northwest Side home, a Chicago IT specialist was convicted Friday of helping the Islamic State terrorist group through a media campaign that encouraged attacks, celebrated beheadings and other gruesome violence and taunted Western culture with memes like a headless Santa delivering a bomb.

U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey issued his verdict following a rare bench trial that began last month, convicting Ashraf al Safoo on 11 counts, including providing material

support to a terrorist organization, conspiracy to transmit threats in interstate commerce, and computer fraud.

Al Safoo faces up to 130 years behind bars when he's sentenced on Oct. 9.

In his brief ruling from the bench, Blakey called the evidence at trial "overwhelming." The judge did, however, acquit al Safoo on a lone count involving \$400 he'd wired to an Islamic State member in 2018, ruling that the evidence was insufficient that al Safoo knew of the recipient's status in the organization, also known as ISIS or IS.

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CPS deficit \$201M more than thought

Former Chicago Public Schools CEO Pedro Martinez said the budget deficit was \$529 million. But that number didn't include a \$175 million pension payment for nonteaching employees, and the cost to absorb several schools in the Acero Charter network. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Mayor's hands full with CHA selection

New CEO tasked with rebuilding trust amid federal uncertainty

By Lizzie Kane
Chicago Tribune

A \$24 million lead paint lawsuit payout. Dissatisfied residents. Staff members who have seen the vast majority of executive leaders turn over in the last 10 months. The Trump administration's priorities to slash the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development's programs and staff.

These are just some of the issues the next CEO of the Chicago Housing Authority, the third largest public housing authority in the country, will face coming into the role.

Mayor Brandon Johnson, who



Angela Hurlock, left, interim CEO of the Chicago Housing Authority, and Mayor Brandon Johnson take part in a ribbon-cutting event for the Edith Spurlock Sampson Apartments in Lincoln Park on Feb. 27. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

has made housing a cornerstone of his policy agenda, must make an important decision in the coming weeks on a new leader for the embattled agency. Some residents and housing advocates, including CHA board member Francine Washington, did not like the way former CEO Tracey Scott conducted business and have told the Tribune they are eager to see someone who is more engaged with residents.

The new CEO will be tasked with rebuilding residents' trust, boosting staff morale and addressing safety and environmental concerns at its properties while shepherding more housing developments in a city where housing has become increasingly less affordable.

"The new CEO will be joining CHA at a pivotal time of transition

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High 87 Low 72

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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